The human nervous system

☞ **1** Use the word bank to complete the passage below:

Word bank

different spinal Nerves back ears backbone sensitive cord changes brain sends muscles central balance messages receive

All **mammals** have a b_____. Inside the backbone runs a long mass of tissue known as the s_____ cord. The spinal c_____ runs from the b_____ inside the skull right down to the tailbone. The brain and **spinal cord** are known as the c_____ nervous system. N_____ run from the spinal cord to every part of the body. Many of these nerves r_____ information from our surroundings. This information is called **stimulus**. The information is sent b_____ to the brain for processing.

There are many d_____ types of nerves. Some nerves are s_____ to touch, some to pain, some to c_____ in temperature. The **optic** nerve s_____ messages to the brain about what we see; nerves in the e____ send messages about the sounds we hear, and also about b_____. The brain responds to these m_____ by sending instructions through our nerves to make our m_____ move or to release **hormones** into our bloodstream.

2 Underline examples of stimulus and circle the examples of how our bodies respond in the text above.

3 On the diagram below, draw and label the parts of the central nervous system described in the passage above.



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